Essentials

New looks from ahead of the curve.

STITCH SWITCH

Preworn jeans have gone the way of the dodo and Jennifer Love Hewitt's singing career. These days, the hippest styles have uniquely embroidered designs and a classic fit, such as these Engedi Chang and Ciano Farmer Black Label jeans ($320). Put 'em on and wait impatiently for your girl to pull 'em off. nordstrom.com

BRAGGING RIGHTS

With its well-positioned opening on the left wrist, the DeSantis Watch Cuff shirt ($125) lets you show off your slick timepiece without so much as raising a sleeve. Take some notes, underwear designers. desantiscollection.com

WRIST ROCKET

Your watch says a lot about you. TAG's Link Automatic ($2,795), with its quartz movement and sapphire crystal, says, "I am a man of action!" Now pick that broccoli out of your teeth. tagheuer.com

EYE TUNES

These second-edition Thump shades from Oakley ($299) have a full 1 GB of flash memory. They fit better, too, which is good news for the man who wants an ultraportable music device sitting on his face instead of an unwieldy machine. Not that Rosie from *The Jetsons* wasn't cute. oakley.com

CLASS ACT

No, Bottega Veneta isn't the name of some fancy Italian restaurant with fantastic wines and a six-month waiting list. But you're not far off, because these classy wing tips ($540) earn a five-star rating in our book. Not to mention how perfectly the vintage leather goes with a nice Chianti. bottegaveneta.com